

ZOKARIO EDITIONS

Night Pages

*Nine short stories for the hour when the house
goes quiet.*

DIGITAL EDITION · 2026



CONTENTS

I	The Dream Ledger	
II	Vacancy	
III	The Two-Person Language	
IV	Winter Apples	
V	The Cartographer's Daughter	
VI	Signal	
VII	The Borrowed Coat	
VIII	Low Tide	
IX	Night Pages	

The Dream Ledger

The first dream that did not belong to her arrived on a Tuesday, filed neatly between two of her own, the way a mis-sorted letter arrives in an otherwise ordinary post. Ines knew it was foreign the moment she woke: it was a dream of deep-sea fishing, and she had never seen the ocean, and the hands hauling the nets in the dream were a man's hands, scarred across the knuckles in a pattern as specific as handwriting.

She was a night nurse on the geriatric ward, which meant she slept while the city worked and woke while it softened, and perhaps, she reasoned, that borderline schedule had left a window open somewhere. She started the notebook the same week, patient and unsurprised, the way she charted everything: one page per dream that wasn't hers. The scarred hands appeared four more times. Then came a dream of a wedding in a language she almost recognised, and a dream of standing in a childhood kitchen she had never stood in, straining to reach a blue tin on a high shelf.

It was the blue tin that undid her calm, because three weeks later she saw it, the same tin with the same worn dent at the corner, on the bedside table of the new admission in bed nine, an old fisherman with

scarred knuckles who had not woken since his stroke, and who was, according to the chart, dreaming of nothing at all.

Ines sat down slowly in the visitor's chair, opened her notebook, and began, for the first time, to read someone their own dreams back.

S T O R Y T W O

Vacancy

The lighthouse had been a bed-and-breakfast for nine years, and Mr. Aldous had been in the lamp room for all of them. He paid monthly, in advance, by cheques drawn on a bank Hedda could never quite find in any registry, and he asked for only two things: that no one else be given the lamp room, and that the light never be switched fully off, decorative though it now was, a heritage fitting on a dimmer.

The story of why is the story of what Hedda finds the one night the storm cuts the power, and of what has been navigating, all these years, by a light everyone agreed was only for show.



*Here ends the open preview. The complete edition arrives
the moment you purchase it at zokario.com, every
chapter of it, with lifetime online reading.*

Z O K A R I O · zokario.com